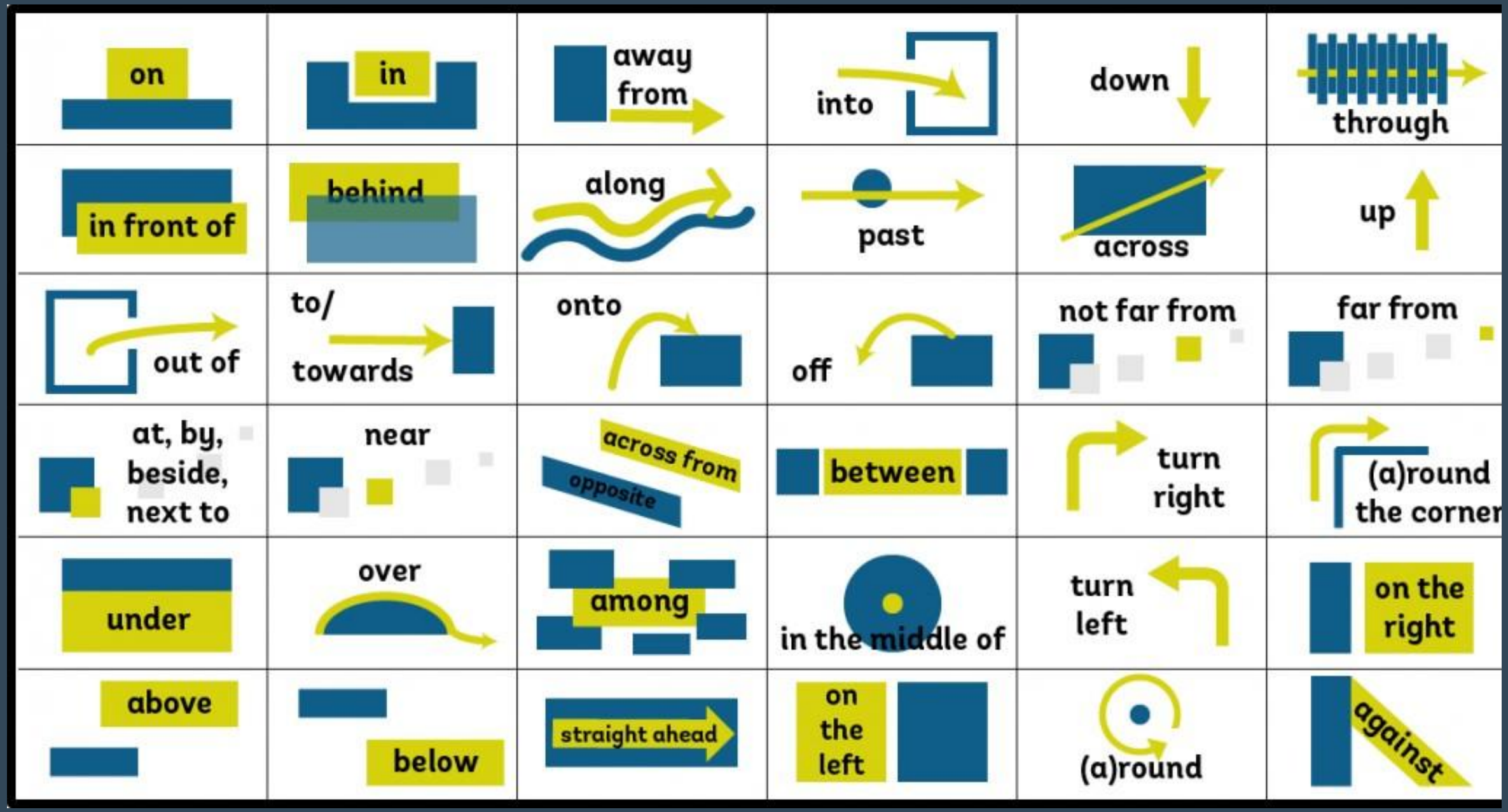
GRAMMAR & BASICS

Prepositions & Conditionals


on
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at, by, beside, next to
near
across from
opposite
between
turn right
(a)round the corner
under
over
among
in the middle of
turn left
on the right
above
below
straight ahead
on the left
(a)round
against

Prepositions

Are used to express:

1. **Time**: in, on, at, after, before etc.
2. **Position**: in, on, at, behind, in front of etc.
3. **Movement**: into, out of, off, across, from etc.
4. **Other relations**: by, about etc.

Getting started: what do you already know?
Using the right preposition

Each sentence contains an error with the underlined preposition. In each case, Try your best to correct it to the right preposition.

1. She is engaged <u>with</u> David
2. She entered <u>into</u> the room.
3. He is intelligent, but he lacks <u>of</u> experience.
4. <u>Except</u> coats or sweaters, you are not allowed to wear outer clothing.
5. <u>On</u> October, we went for a skiing vacation in Switzerland
6. Every summer I fly to Brazil and sit <u>in</u> the beach.
7. He decided to protest <u>over</u> the depiction of violence towards animals.
8. He told <u>to</u> me that he liked it.

KEY
Using the right preposition

1. She is engaged **to** David
2. She entered the room. *[no preposition!]*
3. He is intelligent, but he lacks experience. *[no preposition!]*
4. Except **for** coats or sweaters, you are not allowed to wear outer clothing. *[preposition is needed!]*
5. **In** October, we went for a skiing vacation in Switzerland
6. Every summer I fly to Brazil and sit **on/at** the beach. *[meanings differ slightly, though both are correct]*
7. He decided to protest **against** the depiction of violence towards animals. *[also correct: no preposition]*
8. He told me that he liked it. *[no preposition!]*

Prepositions

- Can be confusing for Dutch native speakers as they are not *always* the same in translation
  - He is **in** the garden → *hij is **in** de tuin*
  - He will be there **in** 5 minutes → *hij is er **over** 5 minuten*

- <u>Find logical patterns</u>
  - If you already know it's "**in** September", it must also be "**in** October", etc.
  - If you know it's "**at** lunch", then it must also be "**at** dinner"

- Other ways to learn them
  - Dictionary
  - Read a lot
  - Learn often used phrases off by heart

Confusing cases - 1

- Some prepositions that look alike or translate to the same Dutch word are discussed on the following slides

- After that some common mistakes based on ‘false friends’

(= words that look alike in two different languages but don’t mean the same) are discussed

Confusing cases – II

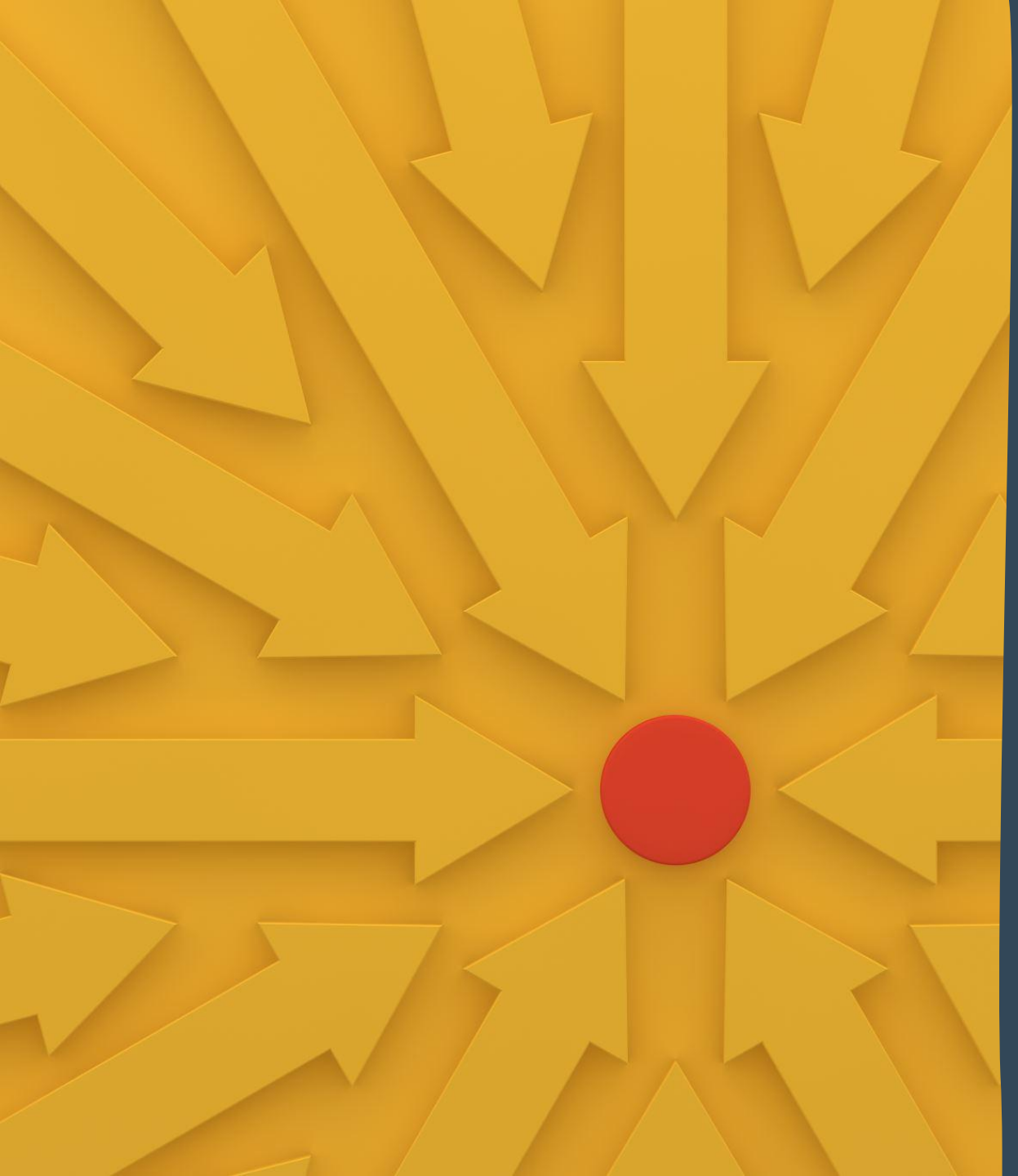
Write a sentence (in pairs or threes) with both and explain the difference between them.

During or for?

- **For** = how long
  - He worked here **for** 2 months.
- **During** = when
  - We met some nice people **during** our holiday.

- Compare:
  - I fell asleep **during** the movie. I slept **for** half an hour.

- Note: **while** is <u>not</u> a preposition, but a linking word, so it's followed by a clause/sentence (with subject and verb)
  - We met some nice people **while** we were on holiday.



Confusing cases – III

Write a sentence (in pairs or threes) with both and explain the difference between them.

- In or into?
- **In** = position
  - I'm **in** the bathroom.
- **Into** = movement
  - He walked **into** the bathroom.

- The opposite of *into* is *out of*
  - I told him to get **out of** the bathroom.

Confusing cases – IV

- **Write** a sentence (in pairs or threes) with both and explain the difference between them.
- To or till?
- **To** = movement
  - We drove **to** Paris, but then we had to take a rest.
- **Till** = time
  - My wife drove **till** 7.00, and then I took over.

- Note: 'too' with two o's is <u>not a prepostion</u>, and can mean:
  - 'also': I saw him **too**.
  - Dutch 'te': He drank **too** much.

Confusing cases - V

Off or of?

Off is the opposite of **on**

He switched the computer **off** and on again.

The book was on the table, but then it fell **off**.

Of is used in all other cases (usually translates to Dutch 'van')

He is the head **of** our department

She cried tears **of** happiness.

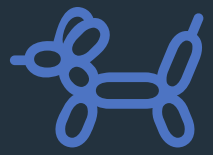
Confusing cases - VI

- Before, in front of or for?
- **Before** = time
  - Shall we meet **before** 7:00?
- **In front of** = position
  - Ok, I'll be waiting **in front of** the restaurant.
- **For** = other
  - I will bring something special **for** you.

Confusing cases – VII

- As or like?

- **As refers to a job or function**
  - He works **as** a clown at children's parties.



- **Like is used to talk about things being similar**
  - He acted **like** a clown in class today.

Confusing cases – VIII

- In time or on time?
- **In time means 'early enough'**
  - I was **in time** for the announcement of the winner.
- **On time means 'at the right time' or 'on schedule'**
  - The show started right **on time**.

Common mistakes by Dutch native speakers - 1

Which is correct? Explain the difference to highlight the error

- I'm not good **in** English
- I'm not good **at** English

- I'm still **at** school
- I'm still **in** school
- I'm still **on** school

- I was sitting **at** the computer
- I was sitting **behind** the computer.

Common mistakes by Dutch native speakers - 1

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- I'm still **at** school
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- I'm still **on** school

- I was sitting **at** the computer
- I was sitting **behind** the computer.

Common mistakes by Dutch native speakers - II

Which is correct? Explain the difference to highlight the error

- I go to school **with** the train.
- I go to school **by** train.

- He has worked here **since** two months
- He has worked here **for** two months

- I am **at** the baker's.
- I am **by** the baker's.

Common mistakes by Dutch native speakers - II

Which is correct? Explain the difference to highlight the error

- I go to school **with** the train.
- I go to school **by** train.

- He has worked here **since** two months
- He has worked here **for** two months

- I am **at** the baker's.
- I am **by** the baker's.

Final exercise

1. _____ 10 o'clock PM, _____ the latest, I will have handed in my essay.

2. _____ one year's time, I will be receiving my diploma!

3. I arrived so early that the main doors weren't even open yet. So I just stood there _____ the building until I was allowed in. _____ a moment I considered walking _____ the building to the back door. But _____ course, I knew it would be locked as well.

4. I'm so bad _____ organizing my day. I hardly even wake up _____ time to eat a proper breakfast. But then again, I have noticed that my 9:00 lecture never seems to start _____ time. My professor is usually five minutes late. I hear she's been doing this _____ many years, but she just gets away with it. I probably arrive _____ school even before she does! Well maybe not, but I'm certainly _____ the classroom, _____ my desk, first. _____ least, most _____ the time.

1. **By** 10 o'clock PM, **at** the latest, I will have handed in my essay.

2. **In** one year's time, I will be receiving my diploma!

3. I arrived so early that the main doors weren't even open yet. So I just stood there **in front of** the building until I was allowed in. **For** a moment I considered walking **around** the building to the back door. But **of** course, I knew it would be locked as well.

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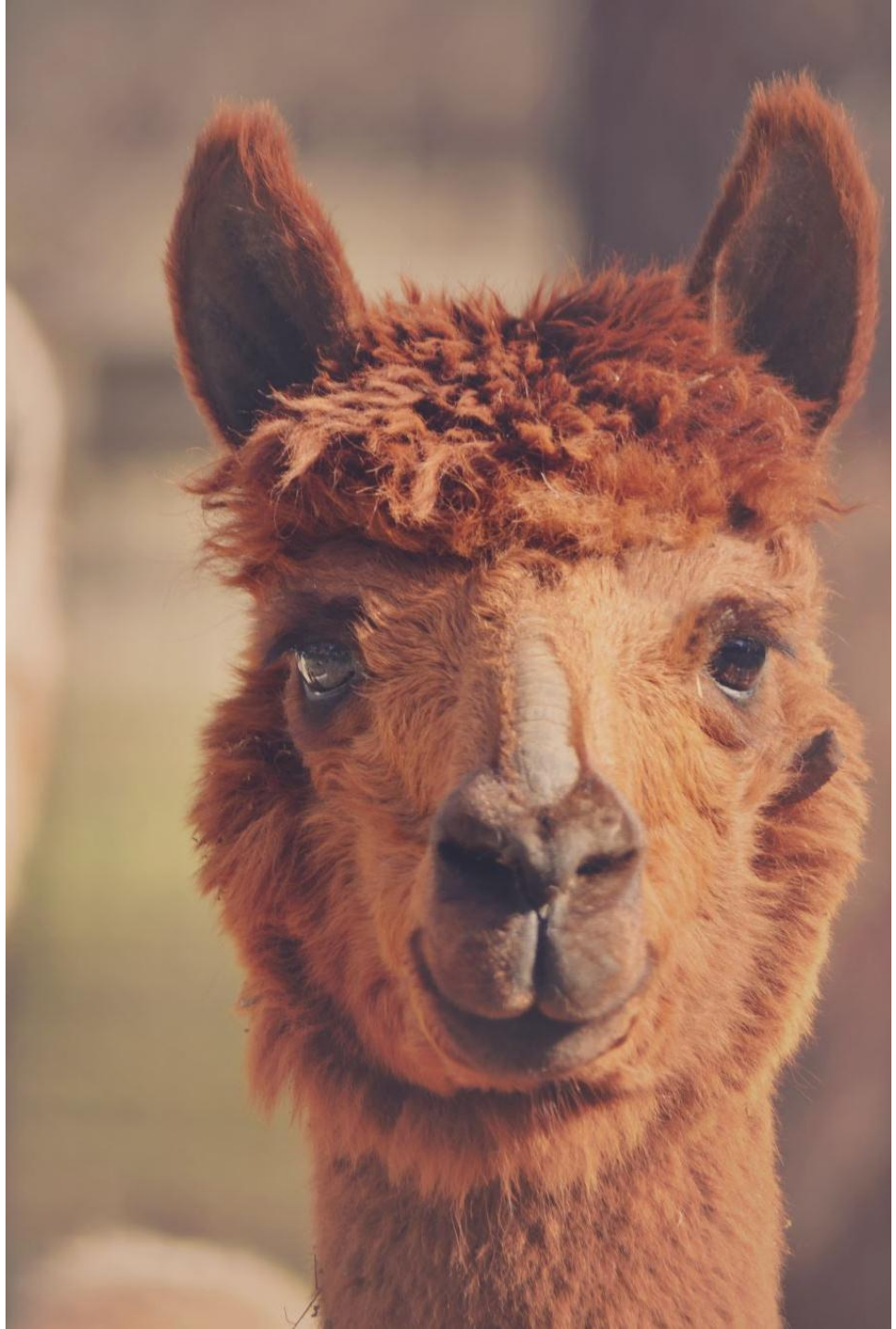

Grammar & Basics

If-Conditionals

GRAMMAR - CONDITIONALS

Week 5

Conditional sentences

What are they?
→"if"-sentences
→3 different types

What do conditional sentences contain? Two clauses:

1. a conditional clause: begins with the word"if" (or "when"/ "whenever"/ "anytime") + VERB
2. a main clause: which also has a VERB

Example: "If I lived another 100 years, I still would not be able to figure this out."
**The "if" clause often comes first, but it doesn't need to.*

Trickiest part about conditionals: getting the verb tenses right.
So here's a run-down of the 3 different combinations of verb tenses you will need to know…

→

All 3 possibilities of verb tenses found in conditional sentences

1. If you **ask** me for help, I **will give** it to you.
2. If you **asked** me for help, I **would give** it to you.
3. If you **had asked** me for help, I **would have given** it to you.

There are specific reasons for using each type, which appear later in the PPT.

For now, let’s use the above information to try to do some practice sentences.

Exercise

The “if” side has already been filled in for you. Based on that verb tense, complete the sentence with a verb of your choice, making sure it’s in the proper tense. If in doubt, use the model sentences in blue to determine what the correct verb tenses should be in each case. (Note: The first blue sentence does *not necessarily* correspond with the first practice sentence, and so on.)

1. If I won the lottery, _____.

2. If she had studied harder, _____.

3. If it is sunny tomorrow, _____.

If you **ask** me for help, I **will give** it to you.

If you **asked** me for help, I **would give** it to you.

If you **had asked** me for help, I **would have given** it to you.

Exercise

This time the main clause has been filled in for you instead. Based on that verb tense, complete the “if” part of the sentence with a verb of your choice, making sure it’s in the proper tense. The model sentences in blue can help.

4. I would have gotten here earlier, if only _____.

5. If_____, I will let you know.

6. We would be so much happier in the world if _____.

If you **ask** me for help, I **will give** it to you.

If you **asked** me for help, I **would give** it to you.

If you **had asked** me for help, I **would have given** it to you.

Conditionals: Fill in the missing verb

Fill in the missing verb in the correct tense. Use the blue model sentences to help you determine what that verb form should be.

1. If I _____ (KNOW) she was ill, I would have sent her some flowers.
2. If my flat _____ (HAVE) a balcony, I would grow plants.
3. Where _____ (you/LIVE) if you could choose?
4. I can't see Mary. If she _____(BE) taller, I could see her.
5. If I _____(PLAY) better, the team would have won the match.
6. If I catch the train at one, I _____ (ARRIVE) in time
7. I would buy organic food if it _____(BE) cheaper. At the moment it is too expensive.
8. She _____ (not/GO) to University if she hadn't worked so hard in school.

If you **ask** me for help, I **will give** it to you.

If you **asked** me for help, I **would give** it to you.

If you **had asked** me for help, I **would have given** it to you.

Conditionals: Fill in the missing verb

KEY

Fill in the missing verb in the correct tense. Use the blue model sentences to help you determine what that verb form should be.

1. If I **had known** she was ill, I would have sent her some flowers.
2. If my flat **had** a balcony, I would grow plants.
3. Where **would you live** if you could choose?
4. I can't see Mary. If she **was/were** taller, I could see her.
5. If I **had played** better, the team would have won the match.
6. If I catch the train at one, I **will arrive** in time
7. I would buy organic food if it **was/were** cheaper. At the moment it is too expensive.
8. She **would not have gone** to University if she hadn't worked so hard in school.

If you **ask** me for help, I **will give** it to you.

If you **asked** me for help, I **would give** it to you.

If you **had asked** me for help, I **would have given** it to you.

WHEN DO WE USE EACH CONDITIONAL?

Explanations & added exercises

Type-1

Type-0. A situation that tends to be true in general.

Type-1. A *specific* future situation that is very likely to be true.

→ Sam, **if** you jump into that pool right now, you will get wet.

(This cannot be Type-0. You can't substitute "anytime" in place of "if", because it's about a *specific* time.)

Verb tenses: if-clause - present simple | main clause - "will"+VERB

*Don't use "will" in the *if*-clause!

If you ~~will~~ jump … / **If** I ~~will~~ win …

Which conditional is suitable to use in a given situation? Type-2

Type-2. Hypothetical situation

When there is great likelihood that the if-clause will be left unfulfilled

→ If won a million dollars [i.e., I'm not holding my breath], I would give you half.

(Here the speaker is imagining a hypothetical situation for argument's sake)

Verb tenses: *if*-clause - **past*** simple | main clause - "would"+VERB

*Although the verb form is in the past tense, Type-2 never refers to a past event.

Don't use "would" in the *if*-clause - If I ~~would win~~ won a million dollars…

One additional form sometimes used in *if*-clauses instead of past simple: "were to"+VERB

→ If I were to win a million dollars… (Possibly even more hypothetical in nature)

Let's try some exercises using Type-1 & Type-2 conditionals →

Which conditional is suitable to use in a given situation? Differences between Type-1 and Type-2

1. Translate the description of the situation below into a single conditional sentence which uses the correct verb tenses.

2. Indicate whether it's Type-1 or Type-2

"It looks like there could well be enough time left in my schedule this evening after I get my homework done. So I feel quite sure of being able to have some TV time afterward."

→ If I _____ (HAVE) enough time, I _____ (WATCH) TV later this evening.

Which conditional is suitable to use in a given situation? Differences between Type-1 and Type-2

1. Translate the description of the situation below into a single conditional sentence which uses the correct verb tenses.

2. Indicate whether it's Type-1 or Type-2

"It looks like there could well be enough time left in my schedule this evening after I get my homework done. So I feel quite sure of being able to have some TV time afterward."

→ If I have enough time, I'll watch TV later this evening. (Type-1)

Which conditional is suitable to use in a given situation? Differences between Type-1 and Type-2

1. Translate the description of the situation below into a single conditional sentence which uses the correct verb tenses.

2. Indicate whether it's Type-1 or Type-2

"I have no reason to believe that we will be able to go back to on-site learning any time before the winter break. I nevertheless enjoy dreaming about being able to see you all to wish you season's greetings in person."

→If we _____ (RETURN) to the HU in December, that _____ (BE) wonderful!

Which conditional is suitable to use in a given situation? Differences between Type-1 and Type-2

1. Translate the description of the situation below into a single conditional sentence which uses the correct verb tenses.

2. Indicate whether it's Type-1 or Type-2

"I have no reason to believe that we will be able to go back to on-site learning any time before the winter break. I nevertheless enjoy dreaming about being able to see you all to wish you season's greetings in person."

→If we returned / were to return to the HU in December, that would be wonderful! (Type-2)

Fill in the correct tenses for the Type-1 sentences

1. If he _____ (HAVE) the chance, he _____ (VISIT) the Vatican.
2. If I _____ (BE) off work for part of the summer, I _____ (TREK) through the Rocky Mountains.
3. If you _____ (CALL) me after 10:00, I _____ (PICK UP/not)
4. I _____ (MIND/not) if she _____ (SHOW UP) early.

If he has the chance, he'll visit the Vatican.

If I'm off work for part of the summer, I'll trek through the Rocky Mountains.

If you call me after 10:00, I won't pick up.

I won't mind if she shows up early.

Q: What did you notice about the verbs in the *if*-clauses?

A: Always <u>present simple</u>!

If he **<u>has</u> (pres.simp.)** the chance, he'll visit the Vatican.

If I **<u>am</u> (pres.simp.)** off work for part of the summer, I'll trek through the Rocky Mountains.

If you **<u>call</u> (pres.simp.)** me after 10:00, I won't pick up.

I won't mind if she **<u>shows up</u> (pres.simp.)** early.

Convert the Type-1 sentences into Type-2 sentences

Type-1

1. If he has the chance, he'll visit the Vatican.
2. If I am off work for part of the summer, I'll trek through the Rocky Mountains.
3. If you call me after 10:00, I won't pick up.
4. I won't mind if she shows up early.

Type-2

If he had the chance, he'd visit the Vatican.

If I were/was off work for part of the summer, I'd trek through the Rocky Mountains.

If you called me after 10:00, I wouldn't pick up.

I wouldn't mind if she showed up early.

Q: What did you notice about the verbs in the *if*-clauses?
A: Always past simple! (even though the meaning is not)

If he **had (past.simp.)** the chance, he'd visit the Vatican.

If I **were/was (past.simp.)** off work for part of the summer, I'd trek through the Rocky Mountains.

If you **called (past.simp.)** me after 10:00, I wouldn't pick up.

I wouldn't mind if she **showed up (past.simp.)** early.

So how do Type-1 & Type-2 differ in meaning again? Let’s take a look at a couple of them

Type-1

1. If he has the chance, he’ll visit the Vatican.

There’s no reason to believe there’s anything standing in his way.

2. If I am off work for part of the summer, I’ll trek through the Rocky Mountains.

I’ve heard there’s the possibility I could be off work, so fingers crossed.

Type-2

If he had the chance, he’d visit the Vatican.

In reality he’s not at all likely to have such luck. But he can still dream…

If I were/was off work for part of the summer, I’d trek through the Rocky Mountains.

However, I already know it’s going to be impossible for me to take off then.

Which conditional is suitable to use in a given situation?
Type-3

Type-3. Past-tense contrary to fact

When the if-clause is already finished and you can't go back in time.

→ If had won a million dollars [i.e., but the lottery is now over, and I didn't win], I would have given you half.

(Here the speaker is imagining a hypothetical situation based on *history having gone in a different direction.*)

It's like saying "If only…".

Verb tenses: *if*-clause – **past perfect** | main clause - "would have"+ 3rd form of the VERB

Don't use "would" in the *if*-clause - If I ~~would have won~~ had won a million dollars…

Also possible with this conditional: leave out "if" entirely. (But if you do that, you need to use word order of a question.)

Had I won a million dollars, I would have given you half.

Let's try Type-3 conditionals →

Make the following into Conditional 3 sentences

1. If he _____ (HAVE) the chance, he _____ (VISIT) the Vatican.
2. If I _____ (BE) off work last summer, I _____ (TREK) through the Rocky Mountains.
3. If you _____ (CALL) me after 10:00, I _____ (PICK UP/not)
4. I _____ (MIND/not) if she _____ (SHOW UP) early.

1. If he had had the chance, he would have visited the Vatican.
2. If I had been off work last summer, I would have trekked through the Rocky Mountains.
3. If you had called me after 10:00, I would not have picked up.
4. I would not have minded if she had shown up early.